During the hot seasons, the hunting grounds of Kābul were bustling with activity. The birds typically followed the path of the Bārān-water. This was because the river was flanked by mountains to the east and west, and it aligned with a significant Hindū-kush pass. Birds had no other convenient crossing route. They couldn't migrate during the north wind or when even a small cloud obscured Hindū-kush. During these times, they would land on the flat lands surrounding the Bārān-water and were captured in large numbers by the local residents.

Towards the end of winter, large flocks of mallards (aūrdūq) arrived at the banks of the Bārān in excellent condition. Following them were the cranes and herons, which were large birds present in vast numbers and flocks.

l. Bird-catching

Along the Bārān, people had used a unique method to capture large numbers of cranes (tūrna), aūqār, qarqara, and qūtān birds. They had employed a special bird-catching technique by twisting a cord as long as an arrow's flight, attaching an arrow at one end and a bīldūrga at the other, and winding it up from the arrow-end onto a piece of wood, which was about a span in length and as thick as a wrist. Afterward, they had removed the piece of wood, leaving behind only the hole it was in. By holding the bīldūrga firmly in their hand, they had shot the arrow towards incoming flocks of birds. If the cord had looped around a bird's neck or wing, it had brought the bird down. This method of bird-catching had been practiced by everyone along the Bārān, although it had been challenging and had required rainy nights. Birds had typically avoided landing on such nights and had continuously flown low along the river until dawn, fearing predatory beasts. During the night, they had used the flowing river as their path, with its moving water visible in the dark. This had been the perfect time to launch the cord and catch the birds.

Another group of bird-catchers in the area had consisted of slave-fowlers, totaling two or three hundred households. They had been originally brought to the Bārān by a descendant of Tīmūr Beg, who had had them migrate from near Multān. Bird-catching had been their trade, and they had employed various methods, such as digging tanks, placing decoy-birds on them, and using nets to capture birds of all kinds. Bird-catching had not been limited to fowlers alone, as every resident of the Bārān, whether through cord shooting, setting snares, or other techniques, had participated in capturing birds.